RSS Digest
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1. Game Boy Color on My Conference Badge
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-27T19:34:18+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/27/game-boy-color-on-my-conference-badge/
Game Boy Color on My Conference Badge I’m at GitHub Universe this week and, similar to last year , the conference badge is a full-blown color screen computer. I’ve been hacking around with it again, and then I ran into with Steve Francia... who worked with Gemini to get a full NES emulator working on it, and then went a step further and deployed an emulator for both the Game Boy and the Game Boy Color. Which means, if you can obtain the ROM, you can run The Legend of Zelda: Link’s Awakening on your conference badge! A neat feature of the badge is that you can turn it upside down and then use game controller touch buttons that are built into the badge body. Tags: games , github , hardware-hacking , ai , generative-ai , llms , gemini , steve-francia

2. Why don?t we run the taskbar and Task Manager at high priority, so they can remain responsive?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261027-00/?p=112800/
Hurry up and wait. The post Why don?t we run the taskbar and Task Manager at high priority, so they can remain responsive? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

3. Siri AI Expands to More Languages in OS 27.2
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-27T22:19:39Z
Link: https://nr.apple.com/Du9G9W8Nq1
Apple Newsroom yesterday: With the 27.2 software updates released today, Siri AI ? an entirely new version of Siri that is profoundly more capable, conversational, and personal ? is expanding to more people around the world, with availability now in the French, Japanese, Korean, Portuguese, and Spanish languages. [...] Siri AI is currently unavailable in the EU in iOS, iPadOS, and watchOS. Apple is working constructively with the EU in an attempt to find a path forward. Don?t hold your breath. (Or if you prefer, N?y comptez pas trop.) ?

4. Apple Creator Studio Updated With a Slew of AI Features, Along With a New Open JSON File Format for Keynote
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-27T22:00:04Z
Link: https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/10/apple-creator-studio-adds-powerful-new-ai-features-and-even-more-creative-tools/
Apple Newsroom, with software news for Apple?s ?Pro and Tell? week: Apple today introduced transformative updates to Apple Creator Studio , the powerful collection of creative apps designed to put studio-grade tools into the hands of modern creators across Mac, iPad, and iPhone. Final Cut Pro for Mac now includes built-in MotionVFX ? an expansive collection of visual effects, plug-ins, transitions, templates, and motion graphics tools ? as well as seamless editing in Pixelmator Pro. Apple?s curated Content Hub now includes video assets and is available in Final Cut Pro. Music creators using Logic Pro for Mac gain a new intelligent assistant in beta, an enhanced Stem Splitter that now separates drums, and a redesigned Browser that incorporates all sounds, with music understanding and even a Splice library. Pixelmator Pro introduces Generate Fill, which lets creators transform selected areas of an image using natural language. Keynote, Pages, and Numbers introduce new AI features in beta, including assistants that understand document context and new Model Context Protocol (MCP) support for workflow automation. They also add stock video in the Content Hub and new premium themes and t...

5. ? Prestructured WYSIWYG
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-27T21:24:20Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/10/prestructured_wysiwyg
Even if you?re a decent designer (or believe yourself to be), it?s liberating not to have a say in the matter. Constraints are sometimes freeing.

6. The Exponential Time Hypothesis is False
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 12:13:21 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/27/eth-false/
If you have an expression in n Boolean variables, how long does it take to find out whether some assignment of values to the variables makes the expression true? There is an obvious upper bound: you can find out in 2n steps by exhaustive search, trying all possible ways of setting each variable to true [?] The post The Exponential Time Hypothesis is False first appeared on John D. Cook .

7. Some thoughts on hosting email
Source: Maurycy’s Blog | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0000
Link: https://maurycyz.com/misc/email_thoughts/
Generally speaking, email isn’t as hard as its reputation would suggest. Yes, big-tech providers will occasionally send my messages to spam... but paying for commercial email doesn’t guarantee delivery: emails within a single provider are generally safe, but in my experience, big-tech to other big-tech has a ~75% chance. Because of this, having my own mail server is great for piece of mind: I can be sure that anyone can send me an email without it mysteriously vanishing. My reply might go to spam, but at that point we’re already in communication and can sort it out. A softer version of self hosting is to keep a big-tech account, but only use it for initiating conversations. Point the "reply-to" header at a server you run, and give that address when people ask for contact details. Since replies to real emails never go to spam, this provides the best of both worlds: maximizing the chance that someone else will get your message, while also maximizing the chance that you will get theirs. Receiving email requires: A publicly routable IPv4 address Any server: good uptime is not required. A domain [optional] Despite it being 2026, many mail servers still don’t support IPv6: if you have a...

8. Book Review: You Could Do Something Amazing with Your Life [You Are Raoul Moat] - Andrew Hankinson ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 12:34:53 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/book-review-you-could-do-something-amazing-with-your-life-you-are-raoul-moat-andrew-hankinson/
It is hard to write a book in the second person. It is even harder to make it this good. It would have been easier to write a salacious cash-in with a dozen shocking revelations in each chapter. Instead, Andrew Hankinson attempts to use Raoul Moat’s own words to build up a picture of the man. You have nine days and your whole life to prove you are more than a callous murderer. Go. It is?

9. We Won?t ?Just Hang Out?
Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Wed, 28 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +1100
Link: https://borretti.me/article/we-wont-just-hang-out
On human connection after the Singularity.

10. MTL-style circuit simulator
Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0100
Link: https://entropicthoughts.com/mtl-style-circuit-simulator
After the first attempt at making a very side-effectful circuit simulator, and then an ambitious attempt at making it pure, I was reminded of a middle ground, using a pattern common in production Haskell code. It is called MTL-style effects , and it is a specific type of final tagless encoding . The idea is that we first find a set of operations that our circuit simulator needs to support. Drawing this boundary well requires some experience and taste. Then we encode that limited set of operations into a type class. Here?s one way to do it. In[1]:

class CircuitOperations m where make_wire :: m Wire get_signal :: Wire -> m Signal set_signal :: Wire -> Signal -> m () add_action :: Wire -> m () -> m () after_delay :: Int -> m () -> m () get_time :: m Int probe_output :: String -> m () propagate :: m () Having read the previous article, these operations should sound familiar. I?m sure it?s possible to create a better set of operations, but this will suffice to illustrate the point. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

11. Inches & Miles
Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-10-27T14:16:43Z
Link: https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17507724/ai-startups-sketchy-behavior
The AI era seems to be emboldening startups to once again take bold swings and use your data without even bothering to ask so they can build a startup around it.

12. Pluralistic: History is something you do (27 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 09:08:25 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/27/tied-to-the-tracks/
Today’s links History is something you do: Not something that happens to you. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Occupy Tents are speech; Piagram; SOPA; "I’m Rob Fucking Ford"; Blocking all porn in the UK; Pirates rule Iceland; Shake Shack v shitting to death. Upcoming appearances: Vienna, Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. History is something you do (permalink) Prediction is hard. Especially about the future. That Yogi Berra gem proves that you don’t have to be a science fiction writer to get irritated with people insisting that you must know what’s going to happen tomorrow, but (as a sf writer), I can tell you that this is one of our main occupational hazards. Obviously, this is a self-inflicted injury. Our genre is full of big names who self-mythologized as scientific Nostradamuses. From the "future history" bar-charts in Heinlein’s books (I was once on a panel with Robert Silverberg where he referred to RAH as "Robert A Timeline") to the McG...

13. Weekly Update 527: Cybergeddon News v. Reality
Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 07:59:09 GMT
Link: https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-527/
As the news from last week has settled down, it would seem this headline was pretty spot on. The foretold apocalypse didn’t eventuate, and there were no internet-destroying outages. In fact, it took days before I could find a single story of PHP2Shell being reliably attributed back

14. The upvote dilemma
Source: Herman’s blog | Published: 2026-10-27T13:05:30.399781+00:00
Link: https://herman.bearblog.dev/the-upvote-dilemma/
Hiding upvotes on the discovery feed

15. I’m Full-Time Open Source Developer Now
Source: Miguel Grinberg’s Blog | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 16:00:42 GMT
Link: https://blog.miguelgrinberg.com/post/i-m-full-time-open-source-developer-now
People get surprised when I mention that I currently maintain not one, not two, but 18 open source projects. For most of my career I handled this work on the side of a day job, but with my day job now gone I am dedicating more time to open source. This is my attempt to advertise what I’m doing a bit better, in case some of you would like to support this work.

16. Noctua Fan Swap on a Calnex Rb/GPS Frequency Reference
Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Tue, 27 Oct 2026 11:37:00 -0500
Link: https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/noctua-fan-swap-calnex-rb-gps-frequency-reference/

Since this will be the only source of this process on the Internet 1 , I figured I’d document a quick fan swap I did on a piece of test/reference equipment I’m running in my Atomic Clock Tower . I took my Torx T10 screwdriver and popped off the top cover. The screws required some force to loosen, as they were all secured with Loctite. The inside is simple and serviceable. There’s a SpectraTime GRClok-1500 , with an integrated timing-grade GPS module, and a stabilized 10 MHz output 2 .